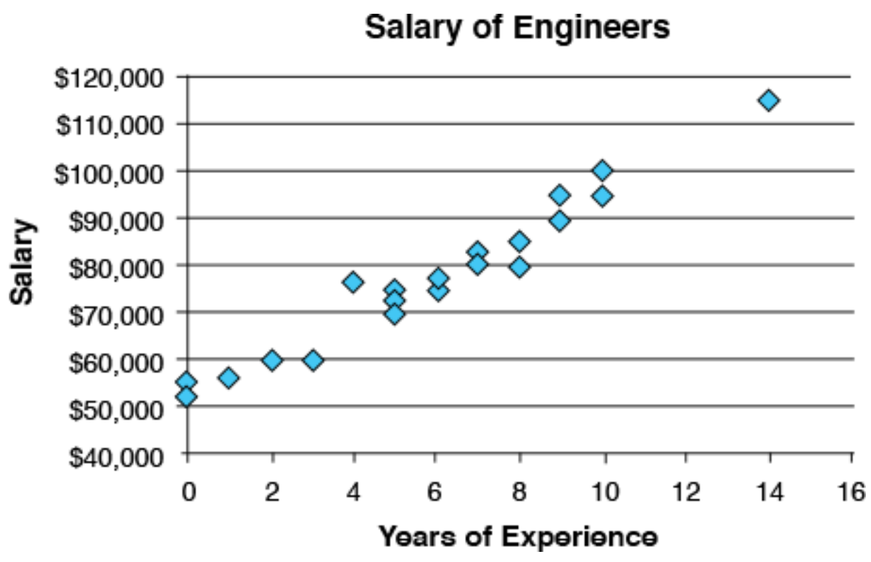
Understanding Dot Plots

A **scatter plot** is a graph that shows the possible relationship between two different sets of data. Scatter plots are useful in graphing the data from a survey or poll.

The table shows the partial results of a survey. A total of twenty engineers were asked their years of experience in their field and their salary.

Years of Experience	Salary
0	$55,000
2	$60,000
5	$70,000
10	$100,000
3	$60,000
8	$80,000
6	$75,000
5	$73,000

The results of the survey are represented on the scatter plot below. In this graph, the horizontal axis represents years of experience. The vertical axis represents salary.

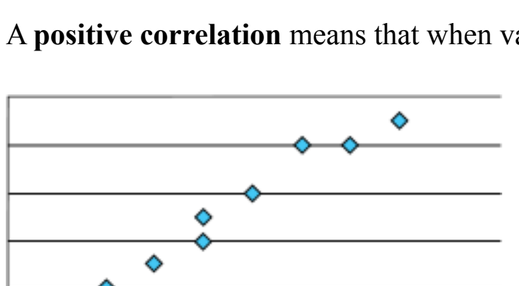


You can find individual points from the survey on the graph, but a scatter plot is meant to show the relationship between the data sets.

Is there a relationship between an engineer's experience and salary? The data on the graph show that the more experience an engineer has, the higher the salary.

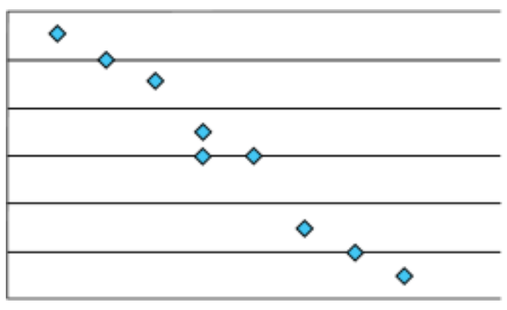
You can say there is a **correlation** between years of experience and salary. You could even identify the type of correlation.

A **positive correlation** means that when values in one set of data increase, the values in the other set also increase.



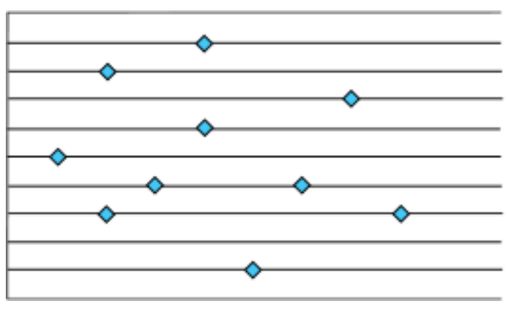
Years of experience and an engineer's salary have a positive correlation.

A **negative correlation** means that when values in one set of data increase, the values in the other set of data decrease.



The number of days absent and a student's grades might have a negative correlation

Sometimes sets of data have no relationship, or **no correlation**.



Hat size and the number of pets owned have no correlation.

Key Terms

- box-and-whisker plot
- lower quartile
- maximum
- minimum
- upper quartile

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Lesson 2: Interpreting Graphs

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